

Visa Inc.

Business Development Dossier

Industry	Financial Services / Payments Technology
Revenue	\$40B
Employees	30,000
Ideal Customer Profile Score	95

ICP SCORING MODEL



ICP = Signals + Revenue + Employees + Fit (max 100)

Signals (0-35)	Top 4 signals scored; each = base(60%) + recency bonus <30d: 40% <90d: 30% <180d: 20% older: 10%
Revenue (0-25)	\$500M-\$10B sweet spot -> 70-100% of 25 pts Below \$500M -> pro-rata x 0.5 Above \$10B -> 60%
Employees (0-20)	2,000+ preferred (70-100%) 500-2K partial (50-70%) Below 500 -> pro-rata x 0.3
Fit (0-20)	High-fit types: reorg, transformation, M&A, hiring, funding, partnership -> 5 pts ea (max 12) + diversity 2/type (max 8)

Prepared March 19, 2026

McChrystal Group

Leadership Advisory & Organizational Effectiveness

SECTION 1

Organization Snapshot

Legal Name	Visa Inc. (NYSE: V)
Headquarters	San Francisco, California, USA
Founded	1958
Ownership	Public (NYSE: V) - Market cap ~\$600B, S&P 500 component
Footprint	200+ countries and territories, offices in 80+ cities globally, regional hubs in Singapore, London, Dubai, São Paulo, and Miami

SECTION 1b

Company Overview

Visa is the world's largest electronic payments network, processing over \$15 trillion in total volume annually across 200+ countries. With \$40B in FY2025 net revenue, Visa is undergoing a fundamental strategic transformation from a traditional card network into a 'network of networks' payments hyperscaler - building Visa-as-a-Service to capture a \$520B addressable market in Value-Added Services. Under CEO Ryan McInerney (since Feb 2023), Visa is aggressively acquiring (Pismo \$929M, Featurespace \$946M, Prisma), restructuring its workforce (1,400-person layoff Jan 2025), and navigating a DOJ antitrust lawsuit that threatens its core debit business.

SECTION 2

Financial Health & Growth Stage

Understanding Visa Inc.'s financial position and trajectory is critical to framing any engagement conversation.

Q1 FY2026 (Oct-Dec 2025): \$10.9B net revenue (+15% YoY), GAAP EPS \$3.17 (beat \$3.14 consensus). Payments volume ~\$4.0T/quarter (+8%), processed transactions 63.8B (+9%). Cross-border volume +11% (excluding intra-Europe).

Growth trajectory: FY2025 full-year net revenue \$40.0B (+11% YoY), net income \$23.4B. Value-Added Services (VAS) now \$10.9B/year (+24% growth) - fastest-growing segment and key to the 'network of networks' thesis. VAS includes risk/identity solutions, issuer processing, advisory services, and merchant acquiring - targeting a \$520B total addressable market.

- Three growth pillars:
1. Consumer Payments - core card network, steady mid-single-digit growth
 2. Commercial & Money Movement (CMS) - B2B payments, Visa Direct, Visa B2B Connect (\$200T addressable market)
 3. Value-Added Services (VAS) - highest growth, 28% YoY, integrating Pismo and Featurespace capabilities

Investment phase: OpEx +16% as Visa invests heavily in platform transformation, M&A integration, and AI capabilities. Capital return remains aggressive: \$3.8B in share buybacks + \$1.3B dividends per quarter.

Key risks: DOJ antitrust lawsuit (filed Sep 2024, motion to dismiss denied Jun 2025, trial likely 2027-2028) targeting Visa's ~60% debit market share; ongoing interchange fee legislative pressure; fintech/blockchain competition (Stripe, Adyen, stablecoin networks); international regulatory headwinds in EU, India, Brazil.

Analyst sentiment: Generally positive on transformation thesis but cautious on DOJ overhang. Revenue growth exceeding expectations, but OpEx growth rate drawing scrutiny.

SECTION 3

Leadership Team Profiles

The following contacts are recommended as primary outreach targets - champion-level leaders who feel the organizational pain daily and can sponsor McChrystal internally.

Jack Forestell - Chief Product & Strategy Officer [PRIORITY TARGET]

Former McKinsey partner, led Visa's product organization before elevation to CPSO. Owns the platform transformation vision, VAS growth strategy, and agentic commerce initiative.

Outreach rationale: Owns the platform transformation that requires cross-functional agility across Consumer Payments, CMS, VAS, and 3 acquired entities. The #1 person who needs Team of Teams to succeed.

Oliver Jenkyn - Group President, Global Markets [PRIORITY TARGET]

Former President of North America. Now oversees all regional P&Ls and client relationships globally.

Outreach rationale: Feels the global-vs-regional coordination tension daily, especially with Europe now operating semi-independently under Cahill. Natural champion for shared consciousness framework.

Additional leadership team members relevant to the engagement:

Ryan McNerney - Chief Executive Officer

Former McKinsey consultant, JPMorgan Chase consumer banking executive. Driving 'payments hyperscaler' vision and Visa-as-a-Service platform strategy.

Chris Suh - Chief Financial Officer

Former Microsoft VP of Finance (Azure, Cloud). Brought in from outside to drive financial discipline during transformation investment phase.

Antony Cahill - CEO, European Operations

Former Mastercard executive, deep European payments regulatory expertise. First-ever dedicated CEO for Visa's European region.

Paul Fabara - EVP, Chief Risk Officer

Former American Express risk executive. Oversees fraud prevention, compliance, and Featurespace integration.

Kelly Mahon Tullier - Vice Chair, Chief People & Corporate Affairs Officer

Former GC, now leads people strategy, government affairs, and corporate communications.

SECTION 4

Organizational Culture & Structure

Culture and structure are often where McChrystal Group finds the deepest leverage. The following signals indicate how Visa Inc. operates today and where friction exists.

Organizational Structure

Matrixed global organization with product-led and region-led dual reporting lines. Historically hierarchical with strong functional silos. Recent creation of standalone European CEO role (Cahill) signals shift toward regional autonomy but creates coordination complexity.

Culture Signals

Glassdoor: 3.8/5 (declining ~1% YoY)

Key employee sentiment themes from reviews and reporting:

- Rigid hierarchy: 'The hierarchical culture is unbelievably strong and rigid' - decision-making concentrates at the top, front-line teams lack authority to move quickly
- AI-driven anxiety: Teams mandated to increase capacity 25% via AI tools; scrum masters and agile coaches eliminated in Jan 2025 layoff, removing connective tissue between teams
- RTO friction: 60% in-office requirement; remote employees report being sidelined or pushed out. Hybrid model creating two-tier culture
- Forced performance ratings: Reports of 10% forced poor ratings to drive attrition without severance costs - eroding psychological safety
- Severance cuts: Severance packages quietly reduced by ~50%, further damaging trust during restructuring
- Political culture: Long-tenured employees described as protective of fiefdoms; external hires brought in to drive change report being undermined by institutional antibodies
- Matrixed slowness: Multiple reviewers cite excessive alignment overhead, slow decision-making, and unclear decision rights as top frustrations

McChrystal relevance: The culture signals describe an organization in exactly the state McChrystal Group is built to address - a hierarchical, siloed structure attempting a transformation that requires speed, trust, and cross-functional collaboration. The gap between the 'network of networks' vision and the organizational reality is the engagement opportunity.

SECTION 5

Recent News & Trigger Events

The following developments from the past 18 months create urgency and provide natural conversation entry points for engaging Visa Inc..

1. 2025-01-15 - 1,400-person layoff across departments

AI-driven restructuring eliminating scrum masters, agile coaches, and middle management. Creates organizational void in cross-team coordination precisely when transformation demands more, not less. Post-layoff culture rebuild is

a core McChrystal capability.

2. 2025-02-20 - Investor Day: 'Network of networks' vision unveiled

Publicly committed to platform transformation from card network to payments hyperscaler. VAS targeting \$520B addressable market. This is the strategic moment - the vision is set, now the organization must execute. McChrystal's operating model expertise is the gap between vision and execution.

3. 2025-05-01 - Antony Cahill appointed CEO, European Operations (new role)

First-ever standalone European CEO signals regional autonomy shift. Creates coordination challenge between Cahill's Europe org and Jenkyn's global markets - exactly the kind of alignment problem shared consciousness frameworks solve.

4. 2025-09-01 - Ended 30-year NFL sponsorship, pivoting to FIFA World Cup 2026 / LA28 Olympics

Major brand strategy pivot requiring new cross-functional activation capabilities across marketing, digital, and regional teams. Replacing a well-oiled NFL playbook with global event activation in an untested model.

5. 2025-10-01 - Launched Trusted Agent Protocol with 10+ partners for agentic commerce

Agentic commerce is a new product category requiring cross-functional speed between product, risk, and partner teams. Early-mover advantage depends on organizational agility Visa's current structure may not support.

6. 2026-01-28 - Q1 FY2026 earnings: \$10.9B revenue (+15% YoY), VAS +28%

Strong financial performance validates transformation thesis but increases execution pressure - board and investors now expect continued acceleration. OpEx +16% draws scrutiny, creating tension between investment and efficiency.

7. 2026-02-01 - Acquired Prisma Medios de Pago (Argentina payments processor)

Third major acquisition in 24 months (after Pismo and Featurespace). Each acquisition adds integration complexity - different cultures (Brazil, UK, Argentina), different tech stacks, different regulatory environments. M&A integration overload is a classic McChrystal engagement trigger.

SECTION 6

McChrystal Fit Assessment

Problem directly maps to McChrystal's core capability (Team of Teams for platform transformation). Multiple active trigger events (layoff, M&A, regional restructuring - all within last 12 months). Clear economic buyers identified (Forestell, Jenkyn). Budget is not a constraint (\$40B revenue, \$5.1B/quarter capital return). Organizational urgency is high (DOJ case, declining employee engagement, 3 simultaneous integrations). Strong fit across all 5 criteria.

Primary Problem

Visa is attempting a once-in-a-generation platform transformation (card network -> payments hyperscaler) while simultaneously fighting an existential DOJ antitrust case, integrating 3 major acquisitions, restructuring its workforce via AI, and managing a demoralized employee base with declining engagement scores. This is a VUCA environment inside a \$40B company - the exact scenario McChrystal Group was built for.

Best McChrystal Capability Fit

Team of Teams operating model - Visa's matrixed, hierarchical structure is the #1 Glassdoor complaint and the primary blocker to the cross-functional agility their 'network of networks' vision requires. Also: organizational design post-layoff, crisis leadership around DOJ litigation, culture change to retain talent during transformation, and M&A integration acceleration across three acquired entities in three different countries.

Likely Objections to Engagement

"We're a \$600B market cap company - we don't need boutique advisory" (counter: size is the problem, not the solution; McChrystal's model was built for large, complex organizations under pressure)

"Our transformation is technology-driven, not organizational" (counter: the technology vision is clear - it's the organizational execution that's stalling, per Glassdoor and restructuring signals)

"Legal won't allow external advisors near the DOJ case" (counter: McChrystal addresses the organizational response coordination, not the legal strategy - keeping operations running while legal fights the case)

Budget is not the objection - procurement complexity and internal politics are the real barriers at a company this size

Competitive Advisory Landscape

McKinsey - strategy consulting (McInerney and Forestell are both ex-McKinsey; relationship exists but may be stale or overly familiar)

BCG - digital transformation advisory (strong payments practice)

Deloitte / Accenture - technology implementation and systems integration (likely already engaged on Pismo/Featurespace technical integration)

Korn Ferry - leadership development and talent assessment (may be engaged on post-layoff org design)

McChrystal differentiator: none of these firms address the operating model and cross-functional decision-making architecture that is the actual bottleneck

SECTION 7

Conversation Entry Points

These questions are designed for a Senior Partner's first conversation. Each opens a thread that naturally leads to McChrystal Group's capabilities without a direct pitch.

1. Jack, you're building Visa-as-a-Service while integrating Pismo and Featurespace into the product org - how are your product and engineering teams coordinating across those three tracks without stepping on each other?

Position as peer conversation about organizational complexity, not a sales pitch. Forestell is ex-McKinsey - he'll respond to pattern recognition and frameworks, not platitudes. Lead with the specific integration coordination challenge.

2. Oliver, with Antony Cahill now running Europe independently, how are you ensuring the global markets org stays aligned on priorities rather than fragmenting into regional fiefdoms?

Frame around the global-vs-regional tension that Jenkyn lives every day. The Cahill appointment created a structural coordination challenge that didn't exist before. McChrystal's shared consciousness framework is directly applicable.

3. The shift from NFL to FIFA/Olympics is a bold brand pivot - is the internal org structure set up to activate globally, or are regional teams still operating the old NFL-era playbook in silos?

Lower-stakes entry point that's publicly visible (sponsorship pivot is well-known). Tests whether Visa leadership recognizes the organizational implications of strategic decisions. Can naturally lead to broader transformation conversation.

Recommended Meeting Framing

Frame as a leadership conversation, not a consulting pitch. McChrystal Group has worked with organizations navigating exactly this pattern: simultaneous transformation, M&A integration, regulatory threat, and workforce restructuring. The question isn't whether Visa can define the strategy - it's whether the organization can execute at the speed the strategy demands. Offer a 30-minute 'pattern recognition' conversation where McChrystal shares what they've seen work (and fail) in similar situations.

SECTION 8

Brand Insights & Market Positioning

Brand strategy reveals organizational priorities and coordination challenges. The following analysis connects Visa Inc.'s market positioning to potential McChrystal engagement opportunities.

Brand Value & Competitive Standing

Visa is the #1 most valuable financial services brand globally and ranks #6 overall in the 2025 Kantar BrandZ Most Valuable Global Brands - ahead of Mastercard, American Express, and PayPal. The brand outscored Mastercard on every dimension of Kantar's Meaningfully Different framework: Meaningful (153 vs. 117), Different (93 vs. 83), and Salient (162 vs. 117). Consumer trust index: 125. Superior performance perception: 135. These aren't close races - Visa's brand dominance in financial services is structural.

But brand value and brand *identity* are diverging. Visa's brand was built on ubiquity and trust: "Everywhere you want to be." That positioning works for a card network. It doesn't work for a payments hyperscaler orchestrating AI agents, stablecoin settlement, and B2B money movement across \$200T of addressable flows. The brand must evolve from "we're accepted everywhere" to "we power everything" - and that transition is underway but incomplete.

The Brand Identity Pivot - From Card Network to Commerce Infrastructure

Visa is in the middle of a brand identity crisis that it's handling better than most companies its size, but hasn't fully resolved:

What Visa was (1958-2020): A card network. The brand promise was simple - wherever you go, Visa works. The logo on a plastic card. The tagline "Everywhere you want to be." Brand trust built on reliability, security, and ubiquity. Consumer-facing, transaction-enabling, invisible infrastructure.

What Visa is becoming (2021-present): A "payments hyperscaler" and "network of networks" connecting 12 billion endpoints across cards, accounts, wallets, stablecoins, and emerging rails. Visa-as-a-Service unbundles security,

analytics, and processing tools so fintechs and banks can use Visa's technology even when they aren't using Visa's payment rails. The brand must now speak to merchants, fintechs, banks, governments, and AI agents - not just consumers swiping a card.

The gap: Visa's consumer brand recognition is near-universal, but its B2B and platform brand is underdeveloped. CEOs, CTOs, and product leaders at fintech companies and banks don't think "Visa" when they think "infrastructure partner." They think "card network." Bridging this perception gap is the central brand challenge of the McInerney era - and it has direct organizational implications because the internal teams selling VAS, Visa Direct, and agentic commerce solutions need a brand identity that matches what they're actually selling.

CMO Frank Cooper III - Culture-First Brand Strategy

Frank Cooper III (CMO since 2022, ex-BlackRock CMO, ex-BuzzFeed CMO/CCO, ex-PepsiCo, roots at Def Jam Records) is running a brand strategy that's more culturally ambitious than any prior Visa marketing era:

Philosophy: Cooper believes "culture shapes what we buy, how we buy, and increasingly, who buys on our behalf." He's positioning Visa's brand around cultural intelligence rather than functional payment messaging - arguing that in an agent-driven commerce world, the brands that understand human identity will win because AI agents will be programmed to reflect consumer preferences shaped by culture, not demographics.

Key moves:

- "Typewriter" campaign (Feb 2025): Reimagined "Everywhere you want to be" for a new generation via a cinematic brand film aired during the Oscars. 15 additional films planned. Shifted tagline meaning from geographic ubiquity to life-possibility enablement
- Ryan Reynolds / Maximum Effort partnership (Sep 2025): "And Some Places You Don't" - a comedic spin on the classic tagline referencing the Fyre Festival. Signals Visa's willingness to loosen brand controls and embrace imperfection. Cooper greenlit a concept Reynolds had pitched years earlier and was rejected. The fact that Visa is now willing to let an actor make fun of its own tagline reflects a meaningful cultural shift in how the brand sees itself
- Agentic commerce brand positioning: Cooper is framing Visa as the trust layer for AI-driven commerce - "if agents are deciding what to buy, then who's programming those agents?" Positions marketers (and Visa) as "guardians of brand humanity" ensuring algorithms preserve joy and surprise
- Visa Pay / Visa Accept / Tokenized Asset Platform: Three new product brands that extend Visa's identity beyond cards - Visa Pay (mobile wallet access without card enrollment), Visa Accept (turns smartphones into card readers for 350M micro-sellers), Tokenized Asset Platform (programmable money, stablecoins, BBVA digital euros)

McChrystal relevance: Cooper's brand ambition requires coordination across product, regional, digital, and partner teams that the current organizational structure doesn't support. A culturally-driven global brand campaign that runs 15+ films across 200+ markets while simultaneously launching new product brands (Visa Pay, Visa Accept) and positioning for agentic commerce requires exactly the kind of cross-functional operating model McChrystal builds. Cooper is a potential influencer contact - his cultural transformation agenda aligns naturally with McChrystal's organizational transformation capability.

Consumer Brand Threats - The Invisibility Problem

Visa faces a unique brand threat: as payments become invisible, so does Visa.

Digital wallet disintermediation: When a consumer pays with Apple Pay or Google Pay, they see the Apple or Google brand - not Visa. Visa's network processes the transaction, but the consumer experience is branded by the wallet provider. As mobile wallet adoption accelerates (59% of European e-commerce, growing to 75%), Visa risks becoming invisible infrastructure - high-value but zero brand salience at the point of purchase.

Fintech brand competition: Stripe, Square (Block), Adyen, and Klarna are building direct merchant and consumer relationships. When a small business owner says "I use Stripe," they're not thinking about the Visa rails underneath. These companies are capturing the brand relationship while Visa captures the transaction - a trade that works financially today but erodes brand equity over time.

Stablecoin and A2A payment alternatives: Open banking (PSD3 in EU), account-to-account payments (Pix in Brazil, UPI in India), and stablecoin networks (USDC, with which Visa itself processes \$3.5B+ annually) create payment flows where Visa's brand isn't present at all. Visa's strategy is to become the on/off-ramp and orchestration layer, but if consumers and businesses don't know Visa is powering these flows, the brand becomes a B2B commodity.

The organizational implication: Visa must simultaneously maintain consumer brand salience (so cardholders keep choosing Visa) AND build B2B/platform brand equity (so banks, fintechs, and merchants choose Visa infrastructure). This dual-audience brand challenge requires marketing, product, and sales teams to operate with different messages to different audiences while maintaining brand coherence. It's a coordination problem - exactly the kind McChrystal's shared consciousness framework addresses.

Sponsorship Pivot - A Brand Muscle the Organization Hasn't Built

The shift from the NFL (30-year relationship) to FIFA World Cup 2026 / LA28 Olympics is the most visible brand strategy change in Visa's history:

What's changing: The NFL relationship was US-centric, single-sport, with 30 years of institutional muscle memory. Every regional team knew how to activate around the Super Bowl. FIFA World Cup 2026 (hosted across US/Mexico/Canada, June-July 2026) requires global coordination across 20+ regional marketing teams, digital product teams, and partner relationship teams - in markets with different payment cultures, different regulatory environments, and different consumer behaviors.

The estimated investment: Visa pays an estimated \$150-200M per four-year FIFA cycle as a top-tier Partner. This makes it one of Visa's largest single brand investments. The ROI depends entirely on activation quality - and activation quality depends on organizational coordination.

What's at stake: If the FIFA World Cup 2026 activation is fragmented (regions running siloed campaigns with no coherent global narrative), it validates the analyst concern that Visa's organizational structure can't support its strategic ambitions. If it's cohesive (a unified global campaign with locally-adapted execution), it becomes proof that the "network of networks" operating model works - not just for payments, but for how Visa itself operates.

Timeline pressure: FIFA World Cup kicks off June 2026 - 3 months from now. Activation planning is already deep in execution. Any organizational improvements McChrystal brings to Visa's cross-functional coordination muscles could have immediate, visible impact on the FIFA activation - making it a natural proof-of-concept for a broader engagement.

SECTION 9

Deep McChrystal Group Fit Analysis

This is the strategic case for pursuing Visa Inc.. It synthesizes findings from all previous sections into a comprehensive engagement thesis with specific fit dimensions, expected outcomes, stakeholder mapping, and a phased pursuit strategy.

Why This Is a Tier 1 Opportunity - The Strategic Case

Most prospects show 1-2 clear signals of McChrystal fit. Visa shows at least 8, and they're all active simultaneously. This section goes beyond the Fit Assessment to explain **why** Visa is among the highest-potential opportunities in the pipeline - and where the fit is strongest, most differentiated, and most likely to convert.

Fit Dimension 1: The Operating Model Gap

The problem Visa can't solve internally: Visa's "network of networks" vision requires cross-functional speed - product, engineering, risk, regional, and acquired entities operating as a unified organism. But the organization was built for a different era: hierarchical, siloed, slow. Glassdoor reviews describe "rigid hierarchy," "excessive alignment overhead," and "slow decision-making." The January 2025 layoff eliminated scrum masters and agile coaches - the very roles that enabled cross-team coordination - while the transformation demands more coordination than ever.

This isn't a strategy problem. McLnerney (ex-McKinsey) and Forestell (ex-McKinsey) have the strategy right. VAS is growing 28%. The platform vision is clear. The problem is that the organization's operating system - how decisions get made, how information flows, how teams coordinate - was designed for a card network, not a payments hyperscaler. No amount of strategy consulting fixes an operating model mismatch.

Why McChrystal specifically: Team of Teams was built for exactly this pattern - a large, hierarchical organization with brilliant people and clear objectives that can't move fast enough because information and authority are trapped in silos. JSOC faced the same paradox: the strategy was clear (defeat AQI), the people were world-class, but the organizational structure couldn't keep pace with a networked enemy. McChrystal didn't change the strategy - he changed how the organization made decisions and shared information. Visa needs the same transformation.

Fit Dimension 2: M&A Integration Overload as a Beachhead

Why this is the best landing zone: Three major acquisitions in 24 months - Pismo (\$929M, Brazil), Featurespace (\$946M, UK), Prisma Medios de Pago (Argentina) - each with different cultures, tech stacks, regulatory environments, and operating norms. The cumulative coordination burden is the real risk: no single integration is likely to fail on its own, but the aggregate load on an already-strained organizational structure creates compounding friction.

The McChrystal differentiator vs. competitors:

- Deloitte/Accenture are likely handling technical systems integration (data migration, API harmonization). They don't address how acquired teams coordinate with Visa's existing product org
- McKinsey might advise on integration strategy (which capabilities to merge, which to keep separate). They don't build the operating model that makes it work daily
- McChrystal addresses the layer neither touches: how Pismo's São Paulo team, Featurespace's Cambridge team, and Visa's San Francisco product org share information, make decisions, and operate with autonomy while staying aligned. This is Team of Teams at its most literal - autonomous teams that share consciousness

Timing advantage: Pismo and Featurespace are 12-18 months post-close - the critical inflection point where cultural integration either succeeds or acquired talent walks. The founders and senior technical leaders who made these companies valuable are evaluating whether they can operate within Visa's structure. If the answer is "no," Visa loses the innovation capability it paid \$1.9B to acquire. McChrystal's framework can preserve acquired-entity autonomy while building the connective tissue to the parent - directly protecting the ROI on these acquisitions.

Fit Dimension 3: Crisis Leadership Under Compound Pressure

The DOJ antitrust case as an organizational challenge: The DOJ lawsuit (filed Sep 2024, motion to dismiss denied Jun 2025, trial likely 2027-2028) targets Visa's ~60% debit market share. This isn't a nuisance suit - it's an existential threat to the core business model. But the McChrystal engagement angle isn't the legal strategy (that's for the lawyers). It's the organizational challenge: Visa must mount a coordinated cross-functional response (legal, government relations, product, commercial, investor relations) while not allowing the litigation to paralyze day-to-day operations and transformation execution.

McChrystal's crisis leadership framework - separating the "fight" from the "run" - is directly applicable. JSOC operated under this exact principle: you fight the current battle AND build capability for the next one, simultaneously, without one consuming the other. Visa needs to fight the DOJ case AND execute the platform transformation AND integrate three acquisitions AND activate FIFA World Cup - all at once, with finite leadership bandwidth.

Fit Dimension 4: The Regional Fragmentation Problem

Cahill's appointment created a structural coordination challenge: The May 2025 appointment of Antony Cahill as CEO of European Operations - a brand-new role - signals Visa's recognition that Europe's regulatory environment (PSD3, interchange caps, digital euro) requires autonomous decision-making. But autonomy without alignment creates fiefdoms. If Cahill's European org starts making product, pricing, and partnership decisions independently of Forestell's global product strategy and Jenkyn's global markets org, Visa fragments into regional silos - the opposite of "network of networks."

McChrystal's shared consciousness framework was designed for this exact tension: how do you give regional commanders autonomy to act on local intelligence while maintaining centralized strategic awareness? The military parallel is direct - theater commanders in Iraq, Afghanistan, and the Horn of Africa had to make autonomous decisions with local context while staying aligned with JSOC's global campaign. Jenkyn and Cahill face the same dynamic: Europe needs autonomy to navigate PSD3, but can't diverge from Forestell's global product roadmap.

Fit Dimension 5: Culture Rebuild - The Trust Deficit

The organizational immune system is rejecting the transformation: Visa's culture signals describe a classic

autoimmune response: the organization is attacking the very changes it needs to survive.

- Forced performance ratings (10% forced poor ratings) erode psychological safety
- Halved severance packages signal that loyalty isn't reciprocated
- AI mandates (25% capacity increase via AI tools) create existential anxiety
- RTO requirements (60% in-office) create a two-tier culture
- Long-tenured insiders protect fiefdoms; external hires brought in to drive change are undermined

The result: Glassdoor 3.8/5 (declining 1% YoY), 68% positive business outlook, and a workforce that's demoralized precisely when the transformation demands maximum engagement and risk-taking.

Why McChrystal, not Korn Ferry: Korn Ferry or similar HR consultancies would approach this as a talent/culture problem - surveys, workshops, leadership coaching. McChrystal approaches it as an operating model problem that manifests as a culture problem. The trust deficit exists because people don't have clarity on decision rights, don't have visibility into why decisions are being made, and don't feel empowered to act. Fix the operating model - clear decision rights, shared information, empowered execution - and the culture follows. McChrystal has seen this pattern repeatedly: culture is the symptom, operating model is the disease.

Fit Dimension 6: The Brand-Organization Alignment Gap

The brand is promising something the organization can't deliver: Frank Cooper III's brand vision - culturally intelligent, AI-forward, globally coordinated, simultaneously consumer-facing and platform-enabling - requires an organizational operating model that matches the ambition. You cannot run a "15 films across 200+ markets" campaign with siloed regional marketing teams. You cannot position as the "trust layer for agentic commerce" when product, risk, and engineering teams can't coordinate fast enough to ship Visa Intelligent Commerce features on time. You cannot activate FIFA World Cup 2026 globally when the NFL-era playbook was US-centric and single-sport.

The brand is writing checks that the organization can't cash. This is a different framing of the same operating model gap, but it's particularly compelling because brand promises are publicly visible - analysts, investors, partners, and employees can all see whether Visa delivers on what Frank Cooper is selling. If the FIFA activation is fragmented, if Visa Intelligent Commerce ships late, if regional campaigns feel disjointed - the brand suffers, and the brand is worth hundreds of billions.

McChrystal's role: Build the cross-functional operating model that lets the brand deliver on its promises. This framing works especially well with Frank Cooper as an influencer contact - his agenda (culturally ambitious, globally coordinated brand execution) maps perfectly to McChrystal's capability (enabling cross-functional coordination across complex organizations).

The Cumulative Case - Why Visa Is a Top-5 Pipeline Opportunity

Most prospects show one strong fit dimension. Visa shows six, all active simultaneously, all reinforcing each other:

1. Operating model gap blocks transformation execution
2. M&A integration overload creates an urgent, bounded beachhead
3. Crisis leadership need (DOJ + compound pressures) demands bandwidth separation
4. Regional fragmentation requires shared consciousness across autonomous units

5. Culture deficit undermines the workforce's ability to execute

6. Brand-organization misalignment means external promises outpace internal capability

No competitor addresses all six. McKinsey touches strategy (#1). Deloitte touches systems (#2). Korn Ferry touches talent (#5). None of them address the operating model architecture that connects all six - and that's McChrystal's category of one.

Revenue potential: \$3M-\$5M+ over 18-24 months (bounded entry via M&A integration, expanding to enterprise operating model, embedding as ongoing strategic advisor). At \$40B revenue with \$16B+ annual OpEx, Visa's advisory budget isn't the constraint - getting past procurement and proving differentiation from incumbents is the challenge.